

Isaiah Hessler

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Computer Science graduate with Honors from California State Polytechnic University Pomona; experienced in game design and narrative writing for TTRPGs. Comfortable working solo and with a team on creative and technical projects; familiar with rapid and iterative development cycles.

Skills: Narrative Design, Creative Direction, Programming

PUBLICATIONS

How to Build a Rocket in a Day

Role: Supervisor / Programmer / Narrative Designer (2026) | [Play it on itch.io](#)

Submission for the GMTK Game Jam 2026, where we earned a spot in the top 4% in Audio and Enjoyment from a selection of over 10.7 thousand games. I took on the role of project lead, directing meetings and development, and making sure all team members were staying within scope. I also worked alongside our lead programmer on creating the minigames and game systems during the development period, and wrote/designed the metanarrative and tutorial the players engage with before gameplay.

- Coded and designed the game in a 96 hour period alongside another developer, 2 artists, and a composer.
- Wrote a short metanarrative for the game's webpage, and included an immersive, simple tutorial and in-game storytelling.
- Lead a team to publish a completed, final product within a short timespan.

Finders Keepers

Role: Supervisor / Narrative Designer (2026) | [Play it on itch.io](#)

Submission for the 2-week Comfy Game Jam Summer: 2026, in which I wrote and structured the NPC dialogue and questline system. The given limitation required "the instructions are a lie". To satisfy this, we built a story that encourages the player to interact with the world in a way that leads to negative consequences, and rewards players for engaging with the narrative. I also sanctioned meetings and ensured we stayed within the allotted scope of our project, keeping all members informed and assisting where I was needed.

- Designed a morality-driven dialogue and quest system that considers various player interactions and branches the story accordingly.
- Wrote over 8k words of dialogue, narration, and item descriptions.
- Lead a team to publish a completed, final product within a short timespan.

My Prison

Role: Solo Writer & Designer (2026) | [Play it on itch.io](#)

A short interactive fiction piece built entirely in Twine about confronting an unknown kidnapper in an unfamiliar place. Designed with the intention to showcase an emotional narrative with branching dialogue.

- Concocted a mystery to unravel within ~3k words, 67 dialogue passages, and multiple endings.
- Self-published on itch.io as my first solo project.

It's Cleanup Day!

Role: Solo Writer & Designer (2025)| [View a critical analysis of this project](#)

This scenario was written for The Contract RPG, a tabletop roleplaying game centered around the completion of Contracts for the mysterious Harbingers, entities that grant people with unladen potential the ability to find their inner strengths and amplify them. These Contracts, written as scenarios, are meant to be played in one sitting as a “one-shot”, and can be any variety of supernatural stories in any setting.

- Wrote narrative, dialogue, encounters, and all supplementary material necessary to run a session of the Contract RPG.
- Provided GMs with an official organization and supporting backstory to use the factions and discoveries in-game in their own homebrewed game settings.
- Crafted a sequential, objective-based adventure with investigative and puzzle-solving element.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Adaptive Networks

Sales Team Lead (Part-Time)

Mont Belvieu, TX

June 2026 - Present

- Trusted with managing funds and inventory in order to keep the store secure, and the day running smoothly.
- Listened to the sales floor and reacted accordingly, ensuring clients left satisfied and coworkers didn't feel overwhelmed; intervened when necessary.
- Strategized proper shift placements for an efficient and productive day, understanding how to prioritize tasks to meet milestone goals.

Adaptive Networks

Help Desk Technician/Team Lead (Full Time)

Bakersfield, CA

July 2024 - March 2026

- Directed projects for client businesses, with direct communication on desired features, saving up to 3 hours of daily tasks per business.
- Lead a group of technicians in timely and efficient task management, whilst training up new employees and exceeding expectations in KPI reviews.
- Fostered lasting relationships with clientele via exceptional customer service and support; became part of the reason several clients wanted to continue service with our company in future contract renewals.

California State Polytechnic University Pomona

IT Student Assistant (Part-Time)

Pomona, CA

September 2022 - December 2023

- Provided technical support for customers seeking assistance with internal student and professor account issues, as well as library hardware and software.
- Serviced our local and server-based print environments via hardware repair and software management.
- Collaborated with peers and other employees to solve internet issues and apply network reservations to school-sanctioned devices.

Coding Minds Academy

Teacher (Contract)

Pomona, CA

August 2021 - January 2022

- Taught Montessori classrooms of 20-30 children aged 1st through 5th grade with an assortment of programming languages, such as Scratch and Java, with a 100% pass rate.
- Coached individual children in making their own projects to be shared worldwide.
- Adapted to multiple teaching styles based on the age range and content to be taught, in order to facilitate a healthy learning environment.

EDUCATION

California State Polytechnic University Pomona

Pomona, CA

Computer Science (GPA 3.69)

December 2023

- Awards: Bachelor's Degree, Magna Cum Laude, President's List, Dean's List, Honors
- Extracurriculars: National Science Foundation Research, Big Data and Cloud Computing Apprenticeship, Kellogg Honors College, Board Game Club